Conjunctions

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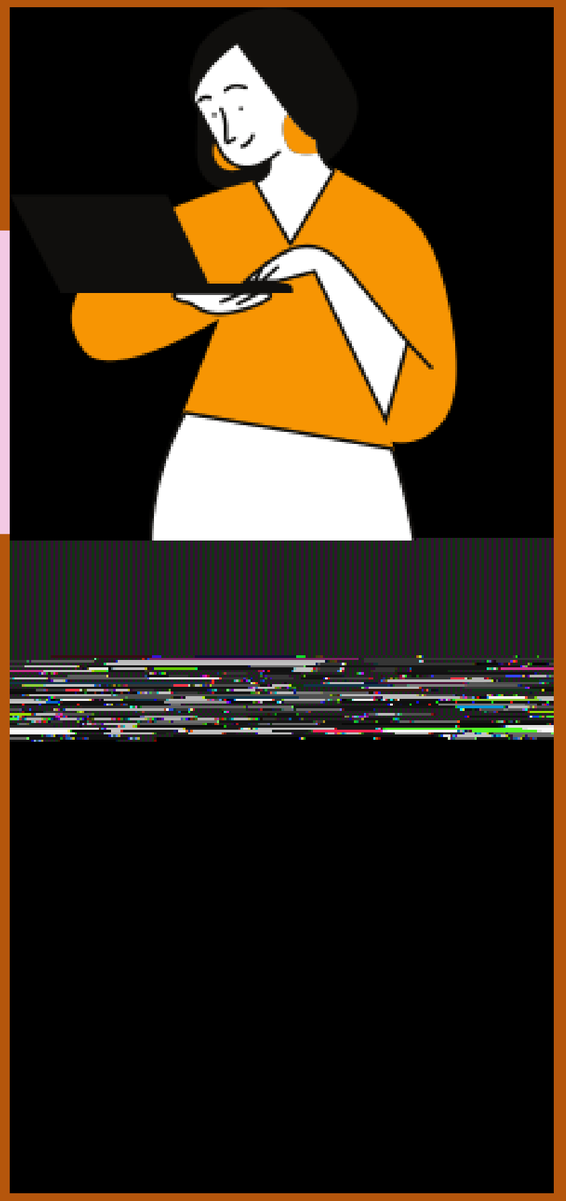
SEE THIS EXAMPLE

I bought bread. I bought butter. I bought eggs. I bought vegetables. I bought fruits. I bought milk.



Does it sound right? No. Have you heard of conjunctions? This article discusses the meaning, definition, types and usage of conjunctions. Also, take a look at the examples and try out the practice questions to have a better idea of the topic.

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DEFINITION OF CONJUNCTION

A conjunction, according to the Cambridge Dictionary, is defined as Ба word such as ѓandђ, ѓbutђ, that connects words, phrases, and clause Merriam Webster Dictionary defines a con uninflected linguistic form that joins together sentences, clauses, phrases, or words.Б A conjunction is Бword that joins words, for example and, but or soБ, according t Dictionary. The Collins Dictionary gives a slightly different definition. According to it, a conjuncti of words, other than a relative pronoun, that connects words, phrases, or clauses.Б

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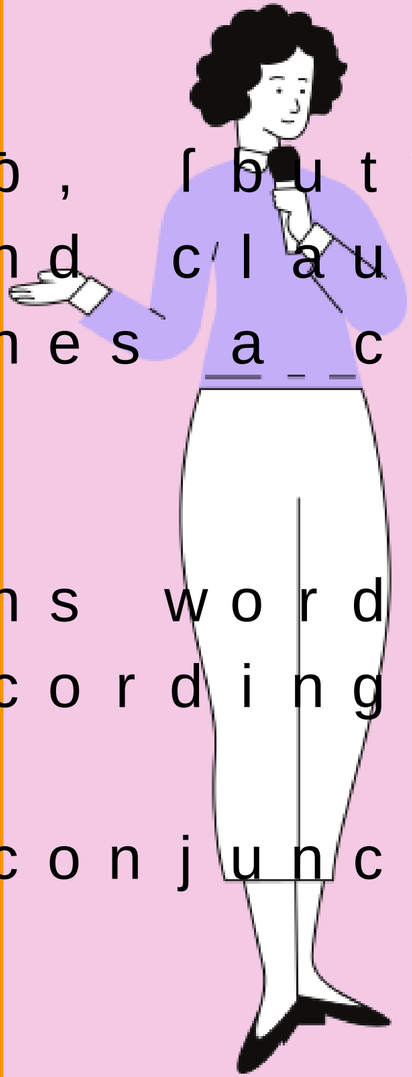

TYPES OF CONJUNCTION

Conjunctions are mainly used to join actions, ideas and thoughts. They are categorised into three main types:

- Coordinating conjunctions – used to combine two independent clauses. Examples of coordinating conjunctions are for, and, nor, but, or, yet and so.
- Subordinating conjunctions – used to combine an independent clause and a dependent clause. Examples of subordinating conjunctions are if, although, though, after, before, because, as if, unless, until, when, while, etc.
- Correlative conjunctions – used to combine two phrases or parts of the sentence which have equal importance within a sentence. Examples of correlative conjunctions are not only – but also, either – or, neither – nor, whether – if – then, etc.

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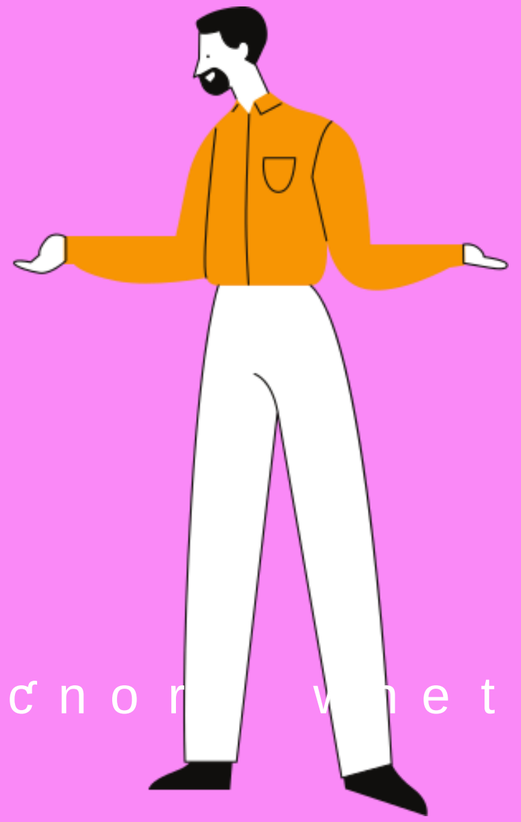

EXAMPLES OF CONJUNCTION

- Ravi and I visited Tirupati last weekend.
- Do you have a rough notebook or at least a rough sheet of paper?
- I did not go to work today because I was not keeping well.
- She did not like the food, yet she ate it.
- I will be leaving tomorrow so I am trying to finish all the pending assignments.

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Types of Conjunctions

There are several different types of conjunctions that do various jobs within sentence structures. These include:

Subordinating conjunctions – Also known as subordinators, these conjunctions join dependent clauses to independent clauses.

Coordinating conjunction – Also known as coordinators, these conjunctions coordinate or join two or more sentences, main clauses, words, or other parts of speech which are of the same syntactic importance.

Correlative conjunction – These conjunctions correlate, working in pairs to join phrases or words that carry equal importance within a sentence.

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Conjunctive adverbs – While some instructors do not teach conjunctive adverbs alongside conjunctions, these important parts of speech are worth a mention here. These **adverbs** always connect one clause to another, and are used to show sequence, contrast, cause and effect, and other relationships.

LIST OF MOST COMMONLY USED CONJUNCTIONS

And	Or	Nor
But	Yet	So
Because	Still	For
Not only…but also		When
While	As soon as	If
Unless	In case	In addition to
Whereas	Though	Although
Until	Before	After
Even if	Rather than	So that
Either…or	As if	Neither…or
Both…and	Whether…or	Or else

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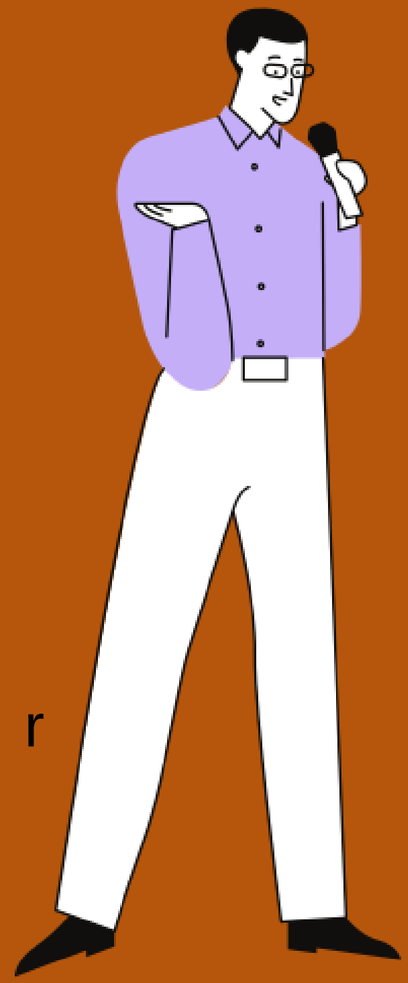

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING OF CONJUNCTION

Fill in the blanks with the most appropriate conjunctions in the following sentences:

1. Deepak _____Santhosh are best friends.
2. Make sure you work hard ____you will not be able to score good marks.
3. _____ Anna does not cook much, she loves baking.
4. Let me know_____ you will be able to make it to the party.
5. I have to go home now _____ I really wish I could stay for some more time.
6. I am not well, _____ I decided to take a day off from work.
7. _____ you work out regularly, you will not see any results.
8. He had no money ,_____he was prepared to help me.
9. I could not find the place _____ I lost the map.
10. _____ I was walking on the street, I found a wounded dog.

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CHECK YOUR ANSWERS

1. Deepak and Santhosh are best friends.
2. Make sure you work hard or you will not be able to score good marks.
3. Although Anna does not cook much, she loves baking.
4. Let me know if you will be able to make it to the party.
5. I have to go home now but I really wish I could stay for some more time.
6. I am not well, so I decided to take a day off from work.
7. Unless you work out regularly, you will not see any results.
8. He had no money, yet he was prepared to help me.
9. I could not find the place since/because I lost the map.
10. While I was walking on the street, I found a wounded dog.

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Exercise- Subordinating Conjunction Exercises

Complete each sentence using the subordinating conjunction from the parenthesis:

1. I visit the Grand Canyon _____ I go to Arizona. (once, whenever, wherever)
2. This is the place _____ we stayed last time we visited. (where, when, how)
3. _____ you win first place, you will receive a prize. (wherever, if, unless)
4. You won't pass the test _ _) _ _ _ _ _ _ _ you s
5. I could not get a seat, _____ I came early. (as, though, when)
6. We are leaving Wednesday _____ or not it rains. (if, whether, though)
7. Pay attention to your work _____ you will not make mistakes. (so that, unless, or)
8. The musicians delivered a rousing performance _____ they had rehearsed often. (though, as, once)
9. She's honest _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ everyone trusts
10. Write this down _____ you forget. (or, when, lest)

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CHECK YOUR ANSWERS

1 - **whenever,**
2 - **where,**
3 - **if,**
4 - **unless,**
5 - **though,**
6 - **whether,**
7- **so that,**
8 - **as,**
9 - **so,**
10 - **lest**

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CHECK YOUR ANSWERS

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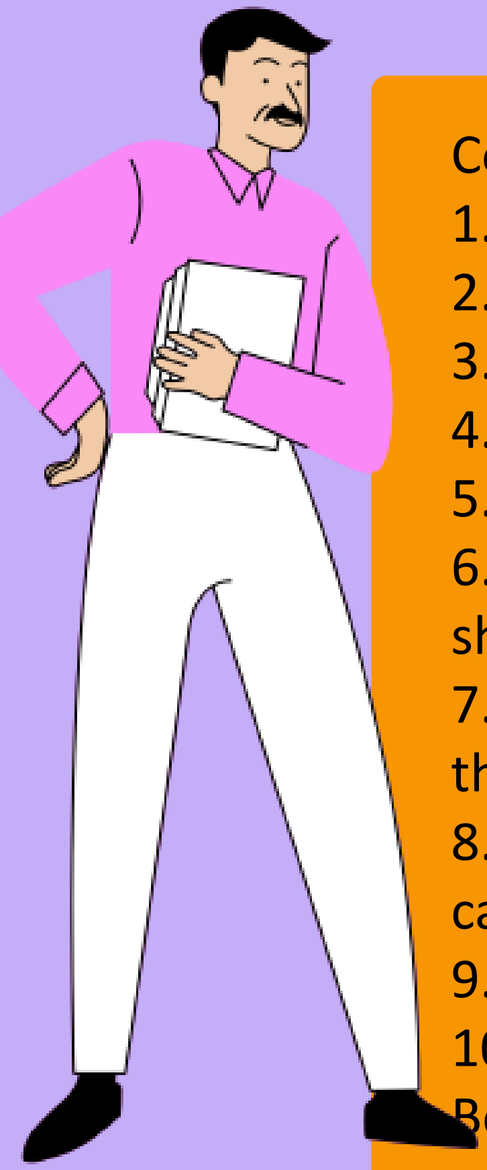
Answers:

1. **Either** you **or** Seetha should make sure to attend the meeting.
2. **Not only** did he find the solution to the problem **but also** helped his friends understand it as well.
3. **Both** Rani **and** Ashwathy attended UPSC classes.
4. **Rather** watch a movie **than** watch a series.
5. Ranjith did not know **whether** he should take psychology **or** sociology as the allied paper.

Exercise- coordinating conjunction



Complete each sentence using the **coordinating conjunction** from the parenthesis:

1. Tom ____ Jack planned to have party at China Valley.
2. See to it that you leave home early _____ you can reach the exam center in time.
3. She reached home late, _____ she looked very energetic.
4. Do you like black olives _____ green olives?
5. I am sure I locked the door, _____ I cannot remember if I took the keys.
6. My friend _____ I had dinner at Patiala House _____ it was the last day before she moved to Delhi.
7. My cousin did not collect the clothes from the dry cleaner _____ did he buy the things required for the birthday party.

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8. He had a lot of sweets to an extent that he could become sick, _____ he says he can have more.
9. The teacher did not ask for you _____ him.
10. I met my friend at Anna Nagar, _____ from there, we went to the Thiruvanmiyur Beach together.

CHECK YOUR ANSWERS

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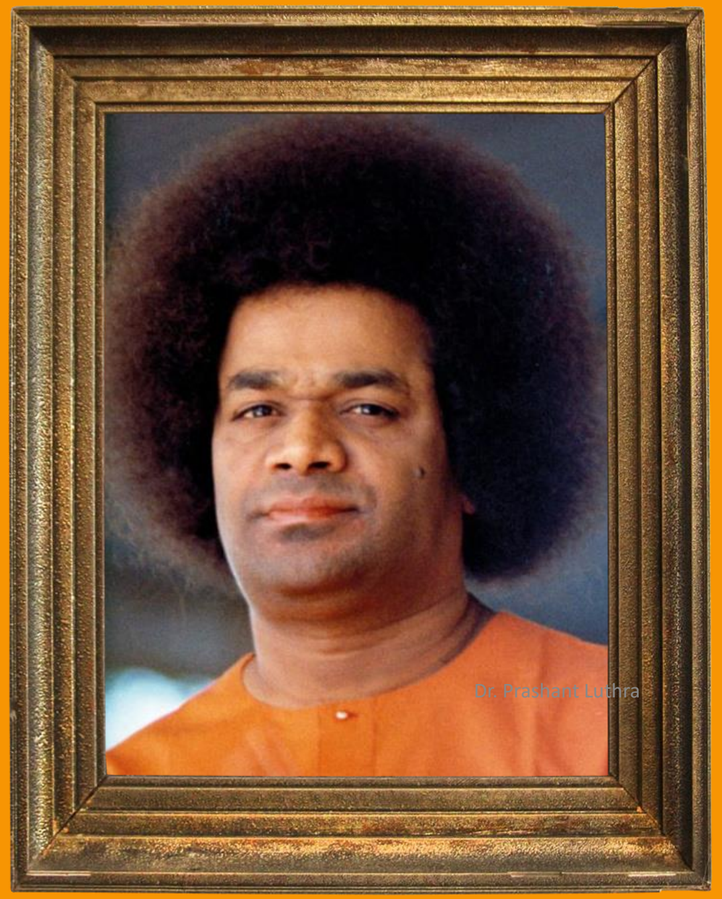
1. Tom **and** Jack planned to have party at China Valley.
2. See to it that you leave home early **so** you can reach the exam center in time.
3. She reached home late, **yet** she looked very energetic.
4. Do you like black olives **or** green olives?
5. I am sure I locked the door, **but** I cannot remember if I took the keys.
6. My friend **and** I had dinner at Patiala House, **for** it was the last day before she moved to Delhi.
7. My cousin did not collect the clothes from the dry cleaner **nor** did he buy the things required for the birthday party.
8. He had a lot of sweets to an extent that he could become sick, **yet** he says he can have more.
9. The teacher did not ask for you **but** him.
10. I met my friend at Anna Nagar, **and** from there, we went to the Thiruvanmiyur Beach together.



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